



PASSWORD SECURITY

PASSPHRASES

A **passphrase** uses four or more random words as your password. The longer the passphrase, the harder it is for adversaries to crack.

Passphrases are easy for humans to remember, and harder for machines to crack. For example, 'crystal onion clay pretzel'.

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STRONG PASSPHRASES

Make a strong passphrase by:

- Making it at least 15 characters long
- Using random words
- Using a unique passphrase for each account

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PASSWORD MANAGERS

Password managers allow you to:

- generate strong and unique passwords
- store passwords and other logins in one place from any device
- save time and effort by automatically entering your password on a login web page
- reduce the risk of someone intercepting your passwords.

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MFA

Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is a security measure that requires two or more proofs of identity to grant you access. Types of MFA:

- Physical security key
- Biometrics, such as fingerprints
- Authenticator mobile app
- Passkey
- SMS

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PASSKEYS

A passkey lets you log in to your online account without having to enter a password for that account. A passkey is like needing a set of two different keys to unlock a door. One key is stored by the provider of your account, while the other is stored either on:

- your device
- a [physical FIDO2 security key](#)

Passkeys provide multi-factor authentication. This can keep your accounts better protected from cybercriminals.